

RAJASTHAN ORIGIN

Aloo Pyaz Ki Sabzi

❖

Potato & Onion Curry

Rajasthan's Simplest Everyday Comfort

AUTHENTIC RECIPE · STEP-BY-STEP GUIDE · PRINTABLE DIGITAL COOKBOOK

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ABOUT THIS BOOK

Aloo Pyaz Ki Sabzi

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DISCLAIMER

Nutrition values are estimates. Cooking times vary with equipment and ingredients. Readers with allergies or dietary restrictions should check every ingredient label before cooking.

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THE STORY BEHIND THE DISH

Two Ingredients, Endless Comfort

Not every Rajasthani dish requires wild-foraged desert berries or an elaborate stuffing technique — aloo pyaz ki sabzi represents the other, equally important side of the region's cooking: a simple, dependable potato and onion curry that appears on family tables far more often than any of the state's more elaborate specialties, precisely because potato and onion are two vegetables that store well and remain available even in a demanding desert climate.

The dish's appeal lies in its straightforwardness — potatoes and onions, cut into similar pieces, cooked together with a warming blend of everyday spices until tender, needing nothing more elaborate to become genuinely satisfying. It's the kind of dish that doesn't announce itself as anything special, yet remains one of the most consistently cooked meals in Rajasthani households, valued for exactly the reliability that makes it unremarkable in the best sense.

For cooks outside Rajasthan looking to explore the region's cuisine, aloo pyaz ki sabzi offers an accessible, low-effort entry point — proof that Rajasthani cooking isn't only about resourceful desert specialties, but also about the same kind of comforting, everyday simplicity found in home kitchens everywhere.

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THE STORY BEHIND THE DISH

Two Ingredients, Endless Comfort, continued

CULTURAL NOTES & OCCASIONS

One of the most frequently cooked dishes in Rajasthani households, valued for its simplicity and reliance on long-storing, always-available vegetables. Represents the everyday, unglamorous backbone of Rajasthani home cooking, in contrast to more elaborate specialty dishes. An accessible entry point for cooks new to Rajasthani cuisine, requiring minimal specialty ingredients or technique. Demonstrates that regional culinary identity includes both distinctive specialty dishes and comforting, universal everyday cooking.

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AT A GLANCE

Equipment & preparation

10m	25m	4	Easy
ACTIVE PREP	COOK TIME	SERVINGS	DIFFICULTY

Recommended equipment

- Kadai or wide pan
- Wooden spoon

STORAGE & MAKE-AHEAD

Aloo pyaz ki sabzi keeps refrigerated for up to 3 days and reheats well. It freezes reasonably well for up to a month, though the texture softens somewhat — still perfectly good for casual meals.

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WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Ingredients

For the dish

INGREDIENT	US	METRIC	INDIAN
Potatoes, cubed	3 medium	400 g	3 medium
Onion, sliced	2 medium	200 g	2 medium
Oil	3 tbsp	45 ml	3 chammach
Cumin seeds	1 tsp	4 g	1 chammach
Asafoetida (hing)	pinch	pinch	chutki bhar
Ginger-garlic paste	1 tbsp	15 g	1 chammach
Turmeric powder	½ tsp	1.5 g	½ chammach
Red chili powder	1 tsp	3 g	1 chammach
Coriander powder	1 tsp	3 g	1 chammach
Fennel powder — optional, traditional touch	½ tsp	1.5 g	½ chammach
Water	½ cup	120 ml	½ katori
Salt	1 tsp	6 g	to taste
Fresh coriander, chopped, for garnish	2 tbsp	8 g	2 tbsp

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WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Ingredients, continued

SUBSTITUTIONS & SOURCING

This dish uses only the most universally available ingredients, making it one of the most accessible recipes anywhere in this cookbook series, requiring no specialty items beyond common pantry spices. Fennel powder adds a traditional Rajasthani touch but can be omitted without significantly changing the dish.

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STEP BY STEP · STEP-BY-STEP

Making Aloo Pyaz Ki Sabzi

01 TEMPER THE CUMIN

Heat oil in a kadai and add cumin seeds and asafoetida, letting them sizzle for a few seconds.

02 ADD ONION AND POTATO

Add the sliced onion and cubed potato together, along with the ginger-garlic paste, stirring to combine.



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STEP BY STEP · STEP-BY-STEP

Making Aloo Pyaz Ki Sabzi, continued

03 ADD THE SPICES

Add turmeric, chili powder, coriander powder, and fennel powder if using, stirring to coat evenly.

04 COOK COVERED

Add the water and salt, cover, and cook on medium-low heat for 15–18 minutes, stirring occasionally, until the potatoes are completely tender.

Texture indicator. the potatoes should be soft enough to pierce easily with a fork, with the onions cooked down soft and slightly caramelized at the edges.

05 GARNISH AND SERVE

Finish with fresh coriander just before serving.

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STEP BY STEP · STEP-BY-STEP

Making Aloo Pyaz Ki Sabzi, continued



MISTAKE TO AVOID

Cutting the potato and onion into very different sizes causes uneven cooking, with one finishing before the other. Cut both into similar-sized pieces for consistent results.

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SERVING & PAIRING

How to serve



Traditional Style

- Served hot with roti, a dependable everyday Rajasthani meal.
- A common side dish alongside dal and rice for a complete, simple family meal.

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SERVING & PAIRING

How to serve, continued

Family Style

- A quick, comforting weeknight dish that comes together with minimal effort and common pantry ingredients.

Modern Pairing

- Works well as a simple, satisfying side alongside any grain or bread, appealing to newcomers to Indian cooking.

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RESTAURANT-GRADE TRICKS

Chef secrets

Getting the Texture Right

- Cutting potato and onion into similar-sized pieces ensures they cook evenly together.
- Cooking covered allows the vegetables to soften fully in their own released moisture, without needing excessive water.

Make-Ahead & Meal Prep

- This dish reheats well, making it a practical, low-effort meal prep option for busy weeks.
- Simple enough to make fresh most days without needing significant advance preparation.

RESTAURANT TRICK

Some Rajasthani home cooks add a small pinch of dried mango powder (amchur) at the end for a subtle tang that brightens the otherwise simple dish.

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BONUS CONTENT

Nutrition, variations & FAQ

APPROXIMATE NUTRITION, PER SERVING

175 kcal	3 g	26 g	7 g	4 g
CALORIES	PROTEIN	CARBOHYDRATES	FAT	FIBER

Estimates only; actual values vary with ghee and portion size.

ALLERGEN GUIDE

Contains, based on the ingredient list: Gluten. Check packaged spices and asafoetida, which may contain wheat, and verify against your own ingredients.

REGIONAL VARIATIONS

Classic Aloo Pyaz Ki Sabzi	the simple everyday version featured here.
Dry Aloo Pyaz	a version cooked with less water for a drier, more concentrated flavor.
Aloo Pyaz with Amchur	finished with a pinch of dried mango powder for extra tang.

Can I make this without onion?

The onion is central to this specific dish's identity and flavor, but a simpler plain aloo sabzi without onion is also a valid, different Rajasthani preparation.

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BONUS CONTENT

Nutrition, variations & FAQ, continued

Why is my dish too dry or too wet?

Adjust water quantity based on your preference — this dish can be made drier or with a bit more gravy depending on taste.

Is this dish very spicy?

No — it's mild to moderately spiced, making it a good, gentle introduction to Rajasthani home cooking.

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REFERENCE

Ingredient glossary



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REFERENCE

Ingredient glossary, continued

GLOSSARY

Aloo	Hindi for potato, one of the two main ingredients in this dish.
Pyaz	Hindi for onion, the second main ingredient in this dish.
Amchur	dried mango powder, an optional tangy addition to this dish.
Sabzi	Hindi for a vegetable curry or side dish.

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PRINTABLE RECIPE CARD

Aloo Pyaz Ki Sabzi

10m	25m
ACTIVE PREP	COOK TIME
4	**Easy**
SERVINGS	DIFFICULTY

DISH

Potatoes	400 g
Onion	200 g
Oil	45 ml
Cumin seeds	4 g
Asafoetida	pinch
Ginger-garlic paste	15 g
Turmeric powder	1.5 g
Red chili powder	3 g
Coriander powder	3 g
Fennel powder — optional	1.5 g
Water	120 ml
Salt	6 g
Fresh coriander	8 g

METHOD

01 **Temper the cumin.** Heat oil in a kadai and add cumin seeds and asafoetida, letting them sizzle for a few seconds.

02 **Add onion and potato.** Add the sliced onion and cubed potato together, along with the ginger-garlic paste, stirring to combine.

03 **Add the spices.** Add turmeric, chili powder, coriander powder, and fennel powder if using, stirring to coat evenly.

04 **Cook covered.** Add the water and salt, cover, and cook on medium-low heat for 15–18 minutes, stirring occasionally, until the potatoes are completely tender.

05 **Garnish and serve.** Finish with fresh coriander just before serving.

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BEFORE YOU SHOP

Shopping list

☐ Potatoes	400 g	☐ Onion	200 g
☐ Oil	45 ml	☐ Cumin seeds	4 g
☐ Asafoetida	pinch	☐ Ginger-garlic paste	15 g
☐ Turmeric powder	1.5 g	☐ Red chili powder	3 g
☐ Coriander powder	3 g	☐ Fennel powder — optional	1.5 g
☐ Salt	6 g	☐ Fresh coriander	8 g

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